

**SECURITYMEN
CARRY WOUNDED
VICTIMS AWAY FROM
THE SCENE OF ONE
OF THE ATTACKS**

Given the size and scale of the hostage crisis, this will go a long way in setting India back economically in the short-term. Says former director-general of police, Dr. P.S. Pasricha, "This was an aggression meant to hurt the psyche of an entire nation. They wanted to ignite trouble in the country and hurt our economy." That was partly achieved on November 27, as the Bombay Stock Exchange shut down. The prime minister made it clear that Pakistan was behind the attack. In his address to the

gators and even the intelligence will have to reorient themselves to cope with the new phase in terrorism. Security agencies will have to go beyond treating terrorists as criminals. They are using the highest level of military tactics and we have to respond accordingly with effective measures," says a Home Ministry official. The prime minister has proposed the creation of a federal investigation agency to deal with terrorism and that existing laws be tightened to ensure that there are no loopholes for terrorists to escape the law.

India also has to ensure better coordination among security and intelligence agencies and tighten up controls on the borders and the coastline and close coordination between state and Central intelligence agencies. India now needs to seek the help of international security agencies. Immediately after the attack, the messages of support for India from the international community, including the new leadership in America, suggest that the time for focused international cooperation has never been more opportune. US President-elect Barack Obama conveyed to Indian ambassador to the US Ronen Sen his strong resolve to fight terrorism.



MANDAR DEODHAR

BY STRIKING HIGH-PROFILE TARGETS, THEIR AIM WAS TO UNDERMINE INDIA'S ECONOMIC SECURITY AND GLOBAL IMAGE

nation, he said that groups behind the attacks were based "outside the country" and used unusually strong words to add that there will be a cost if "suitable measures" are not taken by the neighbours.

How should India respond? It requires an extraordinary response from the Government to deal with this situation. The attack came as a shock for the UPA Government still battling the worst ever year for terror attacks. There is a growing feeling of insecurity and vulnerability in the country. At the cabinet meeting called by the prime minister on November 27, the overwhelming view was that the UPA will have to take a tougher line on tackling terrorism with a combination of stringent anti-terror laws and better ground level intelligence, even if it means curbing human rights and democratic freedom. "The police, the security agencies, the investi-

India also has to demand tough action through the UN and bilaterally for punitive actions against countries that support, finance and shelter terrorist groups and, in case of non-compliance even explore sanctions on them.

Till that happens, Mumbai remains a city under siege, its citizens traumatised, its political leadership lacking resolve and credibility and two of its iconic structures gutted. Mumbai is to India what New York is to America. The attack on the Twin Towers was an attack on the entire free world and was a pivotal moment in the global war against terror. Mumbai's 27/11 needs to elicit the same response. Anything less would be inviting a bigger disaster.

with Saurabh Shukla and Bhavna Vij-Aurora

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